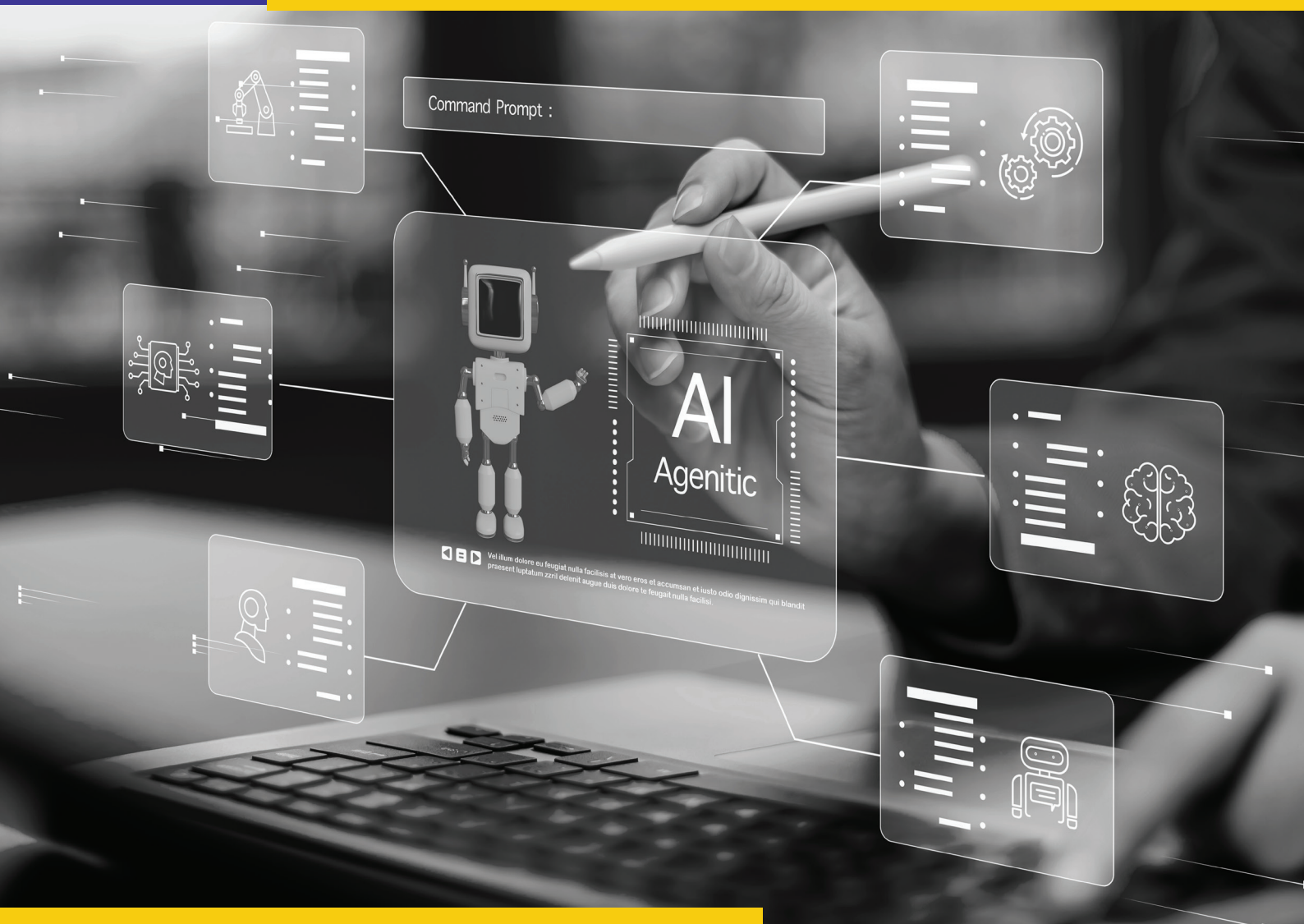
THIS
TORRY HARRIS

Whitepaper

The next operating model - Orchestrating enterprise value with Agentic AI



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Executive summary

From experimental prototypes to enterprise-grade systems that autonomously adapt and execute multi-step workflows, **Agentic AI is redefining the enterprise operating model.** Analysts forecast that by 2029, over 80% of customer interactions will be autonomously handled by agentic systems. Meanwhile, over **75% of finance leaders** expect AI agents to become routine in operations within three years.

Agentic AI is already showing measurable impact in high-complexity domains such as compliance, cybersecurity, DevOps, and customer support. Early adopters report workload reductions of up to one-third in functions like accounts payable reconciliation, as agents reconcile data, enforce real-time policy, orchestrate remediation, and interpret unstructured inputs at scale.

Yet this future will not be achieved through isolated pilots. Unlocking value requires **enterprise-wide transformation**: re-architecting workflows, ensuring interoperability, and embedding governance frameworks for reliability, auditability, and accountability. The prize is substantial: an enterprise where autonomous, goal-directed agents reduce latency, improve consistency, and free human expertise for higher-order judgment.

This whitepaper explores how agentic AI moves automation from rule-following to reasoning-based autonomy, what it means for enterprise architectures, and what leaders must do to scale beyond pilots into enterprise-wide value.

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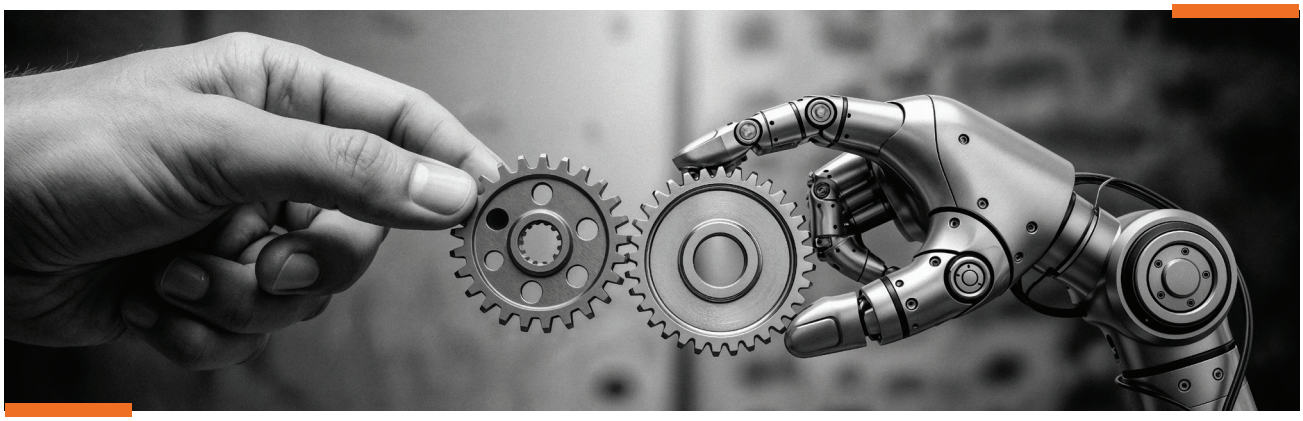
From automation to autonomous value chains

Enterprise automation has evolved in waves, each laying the groundwork for the next:

- **Rule-based automation -** Robotic Process Automation (RPA) and Business Process Management (BPM) codified deterministic instructions for repetitive tasks.
- **Conversational generative AI -** Systems such as ChatGPT and Microsoft Copilot introduced contextual responses and content generation but remained largely reactive.
- **Agentic AI -** Powered by Large Language Models (LLMs) and reinforcement learning, these agents interpret intent, reason probabilistically, and dynamically collaborate across teams and systems.

Agentic AI marks a foundational shift from linear process automation to intelligent operations that evolve over time. Unlike traditional systems that operate within fixed parameters, agentic AI enables autonomous agents to interpret high-level business objectives, adjust to novel situations, and learn from outcomes to improve real-time decision-making with minimal intervention.



A rule-based customer service chatbot can respond to queries for which it was pre-trained. An agentic system can identify gaps in customer information, request clarification, and route complex issues with full context, all while aligning to business goals. In 2025, live deployments are expected to grow. Salesforce's Agentforce enables non-technical users to build and deploy task-specific agents, while Microsoft's NLWeb is working to standardize how agents interact with web content.

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Architecting the agentic enterprise

A scalable agentic AI system requires a **four-layered framework** aligning intelligence, orchestration, execution, and governance:

Core layer: Foundational models

LLMs and multi-modal foundation models form the 'intelligence backbone' of an agentic AI system. These models are fine-tuned on enterprise-specific datasets using techniques like Reinforcement Learning with Human Feedback (RLHF) and Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG). These models equip AI agents with contextual reasoning, intent understanding, and multi-modal perception to interpret complex inputs and generate adaptive responses critical for real-time business decision-making.

Planning layer: Orchestration frameworks

In the planning layer, orchestration frameworks like LangChain and CrewAI enable complex AI workflows. They break down high-level business objectives into manageable subtasks and facilitate seamless communication among specialized AI agents. By autonomously delegating responsibilities and managing interdependencies, these frameworks ensure multiple agents work together efficiently. Beyond internal coordination, they also integrate with APIs, external databases, and event streams, which allows the automation of end-to-end processes across complex enterprise environments.

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Execution layer: Agent mesh and dynamic routers

The execution layer comprises an agent mesh architecture that interconnects distributed autonomous agents, microservices, and AI models via secure, scalable communication channels. At this stage, dynamic task routers continuously assess critical factors, including latency requirements, computational costs, risk profiles, and data proximity to intelligently route each task to the most appropriate agent or model available at that moment. This real-time decision-making ensures optimal resource utilization and responsiveness.

Governance layer: Oversight and ethics

A centralized agent registry continuously tracks and monitors all deployed agents, capturing crucial details such as their versions, autonomy levels, and current operational status. The registry works in tandem with governance mechanisms to translate policy rules into enforceable actions, ensuring compliance through ongoing runtime checks and comprehensive audit trails. Embedded within this governance framework are ethics review processes and escalation protocols designed to provide clear visibility and enable timely intervention whenever necessary.

Analogy: *Just as human employees operate with defined roles, responsibilities, and escalation procedures, autonomous agents must operate under equivalent rules of engagement.*

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Where Agentic AI Delivers Value

Agentic AI is not a bolt-on tool but an intelligent orchestration layer across data, applications, and workflows. Key enterprise-wide opportunities include:

Modernize with agentic AI

Organizations can deconstruct legacy systems, generate dependency and code maps, migrate workloads, and rebuild their application stack with AI precision. Agentic systems analyze siloed data, identify reusable logic, and support modular re-architecture into cloud-native environments. This allows enterprises to modernize selectively without disrupting core business operations and reducing Opex.

Accelerated end-to-end software delivery

Agentic AI enables automation across the software development lifecycle. AI agents can generate technical specifications, compose boilerplate code, write test cases, and initiate CI/CD workflows. By minimizing manual handoffs and reducing development bottlenecks, enterprises can accelerate product release cycles from backlog to deployment in record time.

Operate smarter with AI Ops

With agentic AI, enterprises can introduce autonomous observability into their operations. AI agents monitor infrastructure, application health, and user behavior to detect anomalies, correlate incidents, and self-initiate remediation actions. These capabilities not only improve uptime but also reduce Mean Time to Resolution (MTTR) by up to 40 percent.

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Streamlined QA lifecycle for faster, smarter testing

Autonomous QA agents transform quality assurance by continuously analyzing historical defect data, application logic, and new code changes. They generate adaptive test scenarios, conduct impact analysis, and integrate into DevSecOps pipelines to support real-time release readiness. This results in shorter regression cycles and improved defect detection, offering full visibility from development to production.

Data mesh enablement with AI

Moving beyond traditional data lakes, agentic AI supports the implementation of intelligent, federated data architectures. AI agents can auto-catalog structured and unstructured data, apply metadata tagging, enforce domain-based access policies, and track data lineage across environments. This allows enterprises to govern and serve data dynamically, in line with compliance and business context.

AI-powered marketplaces and CX agents

Agentic AI plays a critical role in powering intelligent digital commerce. By interpreting customer behavior, contextual signals, and vendor information, AI agents can facilitate dynamic vendor discovery, optimize pricing, and personalize customer interactions across channels. These capabilities support seamless, intuitive responses that enhance engagement and drive marketplace performance.

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Industry Applications

Financial services

- **Compliance agents**
  Automate compliance monitoring and alerting across jurisdictions
  Enforce real-time controls and generate digital audit trails for regulators

- **End-to-end KYC orchestration**
  Manage onboarding from document intake and ID validation to background screening and watchlist monitoring via agent chains
  Autonomously escalate exceptions and synchronize with regulatory changes
  Streamline AML (anti-money laundering) and customer verification processes

Real-world example:
Citigroup uses AI agents for compliance monitoring, onboarding automation, and autonomous KYC verification, significantly reducing manual workload and risk.

Sales and customer support

- **AI-driven customer inquiry handling**
  Autonomous handling of multi-step, unstructured customer support interactions
  Clarifies intent, answers complex queries, and escalates ambiguous cases to human agents with rich context
  Integrates multimodal inputs (text, voice, video) for seamless omnichannel experiences
  Reduces agent burnout, improves resolution quality, and enhances customer satisfaction

Real-world example:
Bank of America's Erica virtual assistant powers intelligent, multi-turn support in handling over 50 percent client interactions and reducing call volumes.

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Telecom

- **Network observability agents**
  Proactively monitor and synthesize real-time telemetry across network infrastructure
  Detect anomalies, recommend pre-emptive actions, and escalate critical issues to operators
  Automate performance reporting and incident alerts across hybrid, cloud, and edge environments

- **Agent-led workflow orchestration**
  Manage dependencies and orchestrate responses across APIs, core systems, and services Optimize resource allocation and uptime, reducing manual intervention

Real-world example:
Vodafone uses Google Cloud Vertex AI Agent Builder to develop agents that synthesize data, reduce service downtime, and empower network operators to make quicker, more informed decisions.

Healthcare

- **Clinical documentation agents**
  Extract structured data from unstructured clinical notes, pre-fill forms, and maintain regulatory compliance records
  Automate workflow processes such as patient scheduling, billing, insurance eligibility

- **Diagnostic support agents**
  Combine imaging, laboratory data, and medical history to flag potential diagnoses or escalate exceptions to clinicians

Real-world example:
US-based HCA Healthcare uses AI-based patient demand forecasting for staffing and patient scheduling aiming to boost operational throughput and optimize resource allocation.

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Why enterprises struggle to scale agentic AI adoption

In the current race to adopt agentic AI, the most important question facing enterprise leaders: How do we ensure our investments yield transformative, ™ enterprise-wide value?

The answer is not in technical capability, but in organizational maturity and strategic execution. Most organizations remain in early-stage deployments, lacking a clearly defined path to operational impact and competitive differentiation.

Below is the typical maturity curve for enterprise agentic AI adoption:

Maturity Stage	Characteristics	Value Focus	Traditional Barriers
Level 1 Exploratory	Pilots in sandbox environments	Awareness, experimentation	Fragmented pilots and siloed experiments
Level 2: Task-aware	Routine automation of sub-processes	Efficiency, consistency	Poor data quality, limited integration
Level 3: Process-orchestration	Multi-agent workflows with escalation	Operational agility	Lack of escalation paths, human-in-the-loop policies, runtime oversight
Level 4: Autonomic	Self-adaptive, self-learning systems	Autonomous value creation	Lack of strategic governance for accountability, weak audit trails, and unenforced policy controls

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A number of barriers remain to agentic AI adoption.

Fragmented pilots

Pilots often succeed in controlled environments but fail in live deployments due to integration complexity, organizational resistance, and the lack of operational guardrails. Scaling requires a redesign of workflows that accounts for real-time data dependencies, system interoperability, and downstream impact.

Weak governance and oversight

Many deployments overlook the need for feedback loops, ethical review, and policy compliance checks. Without these mechanisms, AI agents can make unchecked decisions that cause operational or reputational damage.

Insufficient human-AI collaboration models

In high-stakes or ambiguous scenarios, a hybrid model is ideal, where AI agents handle routine tasks and escalate edge cases. Without clear escalation paths, agentic decisions can lead to regulatory errors or operational bottlenecks.

Gaps in data readiness

Domain-specific agents require high-quality, well-tagged information to perform multi-step actions with reasoning accuracy and reliability. However, most organizations face persistent challenges with both structured and unstructured data.

Unclear ownership and accountability

In the absence of clearly defined ownership, it becomes difficult to trace the origin of agentic decisions and resolve errors. Enterprises must assign responsibility for AI agent behavior across stakeholders to avoid disruptions.

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Strategic imperatives for leaders to unlock agentic AI at scale

To scale agentic AI implementation, there needs to be an enterprise-wide shift with regards to architecture, delivery models, governance layers, and mindsets. It calls for a reset of strategies across five key dimensions:

Realign entire processes and AI strategy around business value

Replace fragmented pilots with programs linked to strategic priorities, such as operational resilience, customer intimacy, and risk management. Agentic AI's potential lies not in automating isolated tasks but in re-architecting entire processes. Instead of asking "Where can we apply an agent?", ask "How would this process work if agents drove 60% of it?"

Action: Define transformation scope at the process level, embedding agents throughout the journey. For example, in a KYC process, instead of automating ID validation alone, re-architect the entire onboarding process to be agent-orchestrated from document intake to background screening and escalation.

Establish cross-functional AI squads

AI Centers of Excellence (CoEs) are necessary but insufficient. Cross-functional "transformation squads" must blend domain experts, MLOps engineers, architects, and business operations to industrialize delivery.

Action: Assemble durable teams for each transformation stream, who are each accountable for design, rollout, monitoring, and iteration of agentic systems.

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Operationalize governance and autonomy control

Autonomous agents create new risks, from shadow AI to uncontrolled decision-making. Leaders must implement frameworks that manage autonomy, enforce policies, and protect enterprise data.

Action: Launch an enterprise AI council that oversees agent registries, autonomy levels, and value tracking tied to business KPIs. Classify agents by function (e.g., task executor, domain orchestrator, collaborative agent) with appropriate oversight levels.

Prepare for architecture complexity and model management

As enterprises adopt agentic workflows, the number of models, endpoints, and hosting environments will multiply. Process orchestration tools must be adapted to handle diverse AI workloads while optimizing for cost, latency, and resilience.

Action: Build interoperability via an agentic AI mesh. Enhance orchestration layers to route tasks intelligently across models, LLMs, and agents based on cost, risk, and speed.

Address cultural transformation challenges

Agentic processes challenge static workflows. Workforce readiness in terms of cultural and technical aspects must evolve. Citizen developers, prompt engineers, and AI agent orchestrators are emerging as critical roles.

Action: Invest in skilling programs that pair AI literacy with workflow reinvention. Extend governance to include citizen developers using GenAI-infused tools.

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Conclusion

Agentic AI is no longer a frontier experiment but a strategic imperative for enterprise transformation. As generative models evolve into autonomous, goal-oriented agents, the conversation must shift from experimentation to re-imagining operating models. This demands a rethinking of how value is created and delivered; moving beyond task automation to enabling adaptive, self-improving digital capabilities across the enterprise.

However, the hallmark of an agentic enterprise is not more AI but the intentional design of autonomy, collaboration, and governance at scale. Enterprises that succeed will embed intelligence into the very fabric of their decision-making and execution processes to augment human potential while ensuring control and accountability.

The critical question for leadership is no longer where agents might be applied, but how the enterprise itself must be redesigned for a future in which digital agents co-pilot, co-decide, and continuously evolve in tandem with human expertise. This shift will mark the boundary between organizations that experiment with technology and those that harness it to redefine competitive advantage in the next phase of enterprise evolution.

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About Torry Harris

Torry Harris Integration Solutions (THIS) is a global leader in business, technology, and IT consulting services with over 25 years of expertise in digital transformation. Specializing in digital ecosystem enablement, marketplace implementation, full life-cycle API management, digital integration, AI, and Data, Torry Harris empowers enterprises to unlock new growth opportunities and accelerate innovation. Today, the company is helping businesses worldwide establish Global Capability Centers (GCCs) and drive transformative, AI-powered initiatives that deliver measurable impact.

Headquartered in New Jersey, USA, THIS operates multiple offshore development centers in Bangalore, India, and has a strong global footprint with offices in Bristol and Slough (UK), Dubai (UAE), Riyadh (KSA), Dublin (Ireland), Munich (Germany), Paris (France), and Valencia (Spain).

THIS
TORRY HARRIS

For more information, contact

info@thbs.com

www.torryharris.com/ae-en

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